- The “growing sense of the community of nations”
- The “increasing appreciation of the importance of public opinion
- The “rapid increase in communications”

Features of Traditional Diplomacy

The system of diplomacy, which is referred to as “traditional diplomacy”, is also identified as “old diplomacy”, “bilateral diplomacy”, the ‘French’ or the ‘Italian’ system of diplomacy. Whatever may be the label, traditional diplomacy is characterized by some distinctive features with regard to its structure, process and agenda broadly relating to questions such as: Who is involved in diplomacy? How is diplomatic activity carried out? What is the substance of diplomacy?

Structure: The first and foremost feature of traditional diplomacy, which marked its difference from its predecessors in the ancient and medieval worlds, was that it constituted a communication process between recognizably modern states rather than any other forms of political organization such as the Catholic Church. Traditional diplomacy was also Europe-centric, and five big powers England, France, Prussia, Austria and Spain were the main actors? who could act in harmony to an unusual extent and, hence, the system was often referred to as the *Concert of Europe*. Most of Asia, Africa and Latin America were either isolated or became subjected to colonization. Therefore, diplomacy was virtually *European diplomacy*.

Traditional diplomacy also witnessed gradual institutionalization and by the seventeenth century, the diplomatic institutions became professionalized because diplomacy ceased to be an ad hoc activity and needed a permanent and dedicated workforce of diplomats.

Traditional diplomacy was the monopoly of the aristocratic class and of the professional diplomats who shared a rapport with each other.

Process: Traditionally, diplomacy was organized largely on a bilateral basis and was usually undertaken in secrecy characterized by distinctive rules and procedures. From fifteenth century onwards,